



Run headphones. The brand has spoken a lot about the design of the headphones and how it helps with the overall experience by letting in ambient sound. That does work well; it lets in a lot of ambient noise and creates a wide soundstage, but we will talk about that in the next part of the review. Sony has dropped support for their excellent Headphones Connect app with these headphones.

With a pair of headphones that cost over ten thousand rupees, basic customisation support and app integration are expected. For now, there is not much to talk about. You can receive and end calls and trigger your phone's voice assistant with the onboard controls, and that is about it.

Truly immersive sound

Coming to the main part of my experience with the Sony Float Run headphones – their performance. With these headphones, the keyword that I would focus on is the soundstage. It is massive. In quiet environments, there will be instances where you might forget that you are wearing a pair of headphones and not listening to speakers. These headphones also get fairly loud, adding to the entire experience. It is immersive to say the least. I would also not shy away from watching a few movies on these headphones.

Given the unique form factor of these headphones, I was not able to test their sound signature conventionally, but I did manage to get a reading. And, that should give you a fair idea of how they perform. There is a boost in

the highs and the mids, which adds a lot of fidelity to lyrics in songs and the voice of the callers whenever you are on call. After listening to songs across genres, there is one thing I would say: do not buy these if you are a fan of bass-heavy music. Due to the positioning of the drivers, a lot of the bass gets drowned out, and it results in the tracks sounding flat.

That is a limitation that holds these headphones back by quite a bit. If you are a fan of rock or classical music, or basically any genre that uses a lot of vocals and sibilants, then you are in for a treat. I listened to a lot of heavy metal music and tracks produced by bands like Linkin Park, and the experience was excellent. Now, if you take a track like Animals by Martin Garrix, you will not feel the thump that you would expect. However, instruments and other electronic elements from the track are really clear and loud. When you are in fairly noisy environments as well, the reproduction is on point. You will enjoy wearing these headphones when you are out for a run or working out in a gym. For me, when I was out for my exercise sessions, 60-70 per cent volume level sufficed. The leakage is also minimal. When playing music at full volume, there my colleagues sitting 1 foot away could barely make out the music that I was listening to.

As for the microphones, they worked well in extremely quiet spaces, but when I stepped out, there were complaints of echo coming from the receivers. I tried it across platforms, regular calls, WhatsApp calls, and

Google Meet calls, and the issue persisted. This is something that I would like the engineering team at Sony to take a look at with the next iteration of these headphones.

A battery king in its own right

This is where the Sony Float Run headphones redeem themselves. Sony claims that these headphones can last up to 10 hours on a single charge, with fast charging giving an hour of playback time in just 10 minutes of charge. In my time of use, these headphones lasted around nine hours, which is fairly close to the claimed numbers by Sony and enough for a few workout sessions. Your mileage may vary depending on the volume you listen to these headphones on.

Should you buy the Sony Float Run Headphones?

The Sony Float Run headphones cater to a very specific niche, and in that, they excel. In terms of their comfort and performance, there is not much to complain about. The sound is well-rounded for sibilant and vocal-heavy genres of music and consuming podcasts. Even basic entertainment and calling needs are covered. Bass heads, stay away. These headphones lack in terms of their features; Sony has just added the basics here. But they make up a lot of lost ground with their 10 hour battery, with fast charging support. At ₹10,990, they make for an excellent purchase for fitness enthusiasts who are not afraid of trying out a new form factor. **1**